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PRINCE2® Project Management Foundation

VERSION 7

Syllabus

PeopleCert

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1. Introduction

The PRINCE2® Project Management Foundation qualification is intended for project managers and aspiring project managers. It is also relevant to other key staff involved in the design, development and delivery of projects, including project board members (for example, senior responsible owners), team managers (for example, product delivery managers), project assurance (for example, business change analysts), project support (for example, project and programme office personnel), and operational line managers/staff.

The PRINCE2® Project Management Foundation examination is intended to assess whether a candidate can recall and understand the PRINCE2 Project Management method (as described in the syllabus below). The PRINCE2® Project Management Foundation qualification is a prerequisite for the PRINCE2® Project Management Practitioner exam, which assesses the ability to apply understanding of the PRINCE2 Project Management method in context.

2. Exam Overview

Material allowed	None	This is a 'closed book' exam. The PRINCE2® Project Management Official Book should be used for study but is **NOT** permitted to be used in the exam.
Exam duration	60 minutes	Candidates taking the exam in a language that is not their native or working language may be awarded 25% extra time, that is, 75 minutes in total.
Number of marks	60 marks	There are 60 questions, each worth 1 mark. There is no negative marking.
Pass mark	36 marks	Candidates will need to get 36 questions correct (60%) to pass the exam.
Level of thinking	Bloom's levels 1 & 2	'Bloom's level' describes the type of thinking needed to answer the question. For Bloom's level 1 questions, candidates need to **recall** information about the PRINCE2 Project Management method. For Bloom's level 2 questions, candidates need to show **understanding** of these concepts.
Question types	Standard, missing word, list, and negative	The questions are all 'multiple choice'. For the 'standard' questions, candidates have a question and four answer options. 'Negative' questions are 'standard' question in which the stem is negatively worded. For the 'missing word' questions, there is a sentence with a word missing and candidates have to select the missing word from four options. For the 'list' questions, there is a list of four statements, and candidates have to select the two correct statements.

3. Question Types

All questions are Objective Test Questions (OTQs), which present four options from which one option is selected. Distractors (wrong answers) are options that candidates with incomplete knowledge or skill would be likely to choose. These are generally plausible responses relating to the syllabus area being examined. Question styles used within this type are: 'standard', 'missing word', 'list' (2 correct items), and, exceptionally, 'negative' standard OTQ.

Example 'standard' question:
Which is one of the five integrated elements within PRINCE2 Project Management?

A. Quality
B. Role descriptions
C. Processes
D. Product descriptions

Example 'list' question:
Which two statements about tailoring are **CORRECT**?

1. Processes can be simplified or carried out in more detail.
2. Terminology can be changed to suit organizational standards.
3. Elements that are not relevant to the project can be excluded.
4. Project management team members can carry out any combination of roles.

A. 1 and 2
B. 2 and 3
C. 3 and 4
D. 1 and 4

NOTE: Two of the list items are correct.

Example 'missing word' question:

Identify the missing word in the following sentence.

A purpose of the [?] practice is to control any deviations causing an exception.

A. change
B. plans
C. progress
D. risk

Example 'negative' question:
Which is **NOT** a role within PRINCE2 Project Management?

A. Role A
B. Role B
C. Role C
D. Role D

NOTE: Negative questions are only used as an exception, where part of the learning outcome is to know that something is not done or should not occur.

Please see the sample paper for an example of the exam format and content.

4. Syllabus

The tables below give a summary of the concepts that are tested in the exam, and the main parts of the Official Book in which these are described. The book references refer to the section, but not the subsections within that section, unless specifically stated.

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria	Bloom's Level
1. Understand key concepts relating to projects and PRINCE2 Project Management	1.1 Recall key concepts related to project management: a) the definition of the integrated elements of PRINCE2 Project Management: principles, people, practices, processes and the project context (1.2, Figure 1.1) b) the definition of a project and project management (1.3, 1.4) c) the aspects of project performance to be managed (1.4) d) the definition of delivery approaches: linear-sequential, iterative-incremental, hybrid (1.5.3)	BL1
	1.2 Describe key concepts related to project management: a) the common reasons why project management is used (1.3) b) the common challenges that PRINCE2 Project Management is designed to address (1.4) c) the characteristics of a project (1.3) d) projects in context/project environment (1.5, including subsections except 1.5.3) e) the features and benefits of PRINCE2 Project Management (1.6)	BL2
2. Understand how the PRINCE2 Project Management principles underpin the PRINCE2 Project Management method	2.1 Explain the PRINCE2 Project Management principles: • ensure continued business justification (2.1) • learn from experience (2.2) • define roles, responsibilities, and relationships (2.3) • manage by stages (2.4) • manage by exception (2.5) • focus on products (2.6) • tailor to suit the project (2.7)	BL2
	2.2 Explain how and why the principles provide the basis of applying PRINCE2 Project Management, and which factors influence the way the PRINCE2 Project Management method can be tailored and applied, who is responsible, and how tailoring decisions are documented (2, 2.7, Figure 2.1)	BL2
3. Understand the importance of people in successful projects	3.1 Define key concepts related to the people element: • organizational ecosystem (3.1, Figure 3.1) • project ecosystem (3.1, Figure 3.1) • change management (3.2.1) • stakeholder (3.2.2) • culture (3.2.3) • collaboration and co-creation (3.3) • leadership (3.3) • management (3.3)	BL1

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria	Bloom's Level
	3.2 Explain the difference between concepts related to the people element: • people within the project and people affected by the project (3.1) • leadership and management (3.3)	BL2
	3.3 Explain key concepts related to the people element: • change management and why it is important (3.2.1) • stakeholder engagement (3.2.2) • communication (3.4) • effective teams, including diversity, capability and competence (3.3, including subsections)	BL2
	3.4 Explain the purpose of the management products required to support the people element of projects: • PID: change management approach (3.2.1) • PID: communication management approach (3.4)	BL2
	3.5 Explain how people aspects integrate with other PRINCE2 Project Management elements (3.5, including subsections)	BL2
4. Understand the PRINCE2 Project Management practices and how they are applied throughout the project	4.1 Explain the purpose of management products in PRINCE2 Project Management, including: • PID (4.3.1) • Project log (4.3.2)	BL2
	4.1.1 Explain the purpose of the business case practice (5.1)	BL2
	4.1.2 Describe the key relationships between the business case practice and the principles (5.7, Table 5.2)	BL2
	4.1.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the business case practice (5.5): • project brief • business case • PID: benefits management approach • PID: sustainability management approach	BL2
	4.1.4 Define key concepts related to the business case practice (5.1): • output • outcome • benefit • dis-benefit • business objective	BL1
	4.1.5 Describe the guidance for effective management of the business case, including (5.2): • business case lifecycle (5.2.1, Figure 5.2, Figure 5.3) • aligning products to business objectives and tolerances (5.2.2) • establishing business justification (5.2.3)	BL2
	4.1.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the business case practice (5.3.1, including subsections)	BL2
	4.2.1 Explain the purpose of the organization practice (6.1)	BL2
	4.2.2 Describe the key relationships between the organization practice and the principles (6.7, Table 6.5)	BL2

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria	Bloom's Level
	4.2.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the organization practice: (6.5) • PID: project management team structure • PID: role descriptions • PID: commercial management approach	BL2
	4.2.4 Define key concepts related to the organization practice: • project board (6.2.1, 6.2.4.4) • project team (6.2.3)	BL1
	4.2.5 Describe the guidance for effective organizing of: • the three project interests (6.2.1) • PRINCE2 Project Management roles (6.2.4, including subsections) • work breakdown structure (6.2.5)	BL2
	4.2.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the organization practice (6.3.1, including subsections)	BL2
	4.3.1 Explain the purpose of the plans practice (7.1)	BL2
	4.3.2 Describe the key relationships between the plans practice and the principles (7.7, Table 7.2)	BL2
	4.3.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the plans practice (7.5): • work package description • project product description • plan, including project, stage, team and exception plans (7.2.2, including subsections)	BL2
	4.3.4 Define key concepts related to the plans practice: • schedule (7.3.1.4) • dependency (7.3.1.2) • project plan (7.2.2.1) • stage plan (7.2.2.2) • team plan (7.2.2.3) • exception plan (7.2.2.4) • scope (7.1.2)	BL1
	4.3.5 Describe the guidance for effective management of plans: • the planning horizon (7.2.1) • project stages (7.2.3, including subsections) • product-based planning (7.2.5) • using tolerances to manage constraints (7.2.4)	BL2
	4.3.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the plans practice (7.3.1, including subsections)	BL2
	4.4.1 Explain the purpose of the quality practice (8.1)	BL2
	4.4.2 Describe the key relationships between the quality practice and the principles (8.7, Table 8.3)	BL2
	4.4.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the quality practice (8.5): • product description • PID: quality management approach • project log: quality register • project log: product register	BL2

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria	Bloom's Level
	4.4.4 Define key concepts related to the quality practice: • user quality expectations (8.1.1, 8.2.1.1) • acceptance criteria (8.1.1) • quality specifications (8.1.1) • requirements (8.1.1)	BL1
	4.4.5 Describe the guidance for effective management of quality: • quality planning (8.2.1, including subsections) • quality control (8.2.2) • quality assurance (8.2.3)	BL2
	4.4.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the quality practice (8.3.1, including subsections)	BL2
	4.5.1 Explain the purpose of the risk practice (9.1)	BL2
	4.5.2 Describe the key relationships between the risk practice and the principles (9.7, Table 9.4)	BL2
	4.5.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the risk practice (9.5): • PID: risk management approach • Project log: risk register	BL2
	4.5.4 Define key concepts related to the risk practice: • a risk: threat or opportunity based on uncertainty (9.1) • risk appetite (9.2) • risk tolerance (9.2) • risk cause, event and effect (9.2.1) • risk exposure (9.2) • risk owner and risk action owner (9.2) • risk probability (9.2) • risk impact (9.2)	BL1
	4.5.5 Describe the guidance for effective management of risk: • risk planning (9.2.1) • risk analysis (9.2.2) • risk control (9.2.3, including subsections) • risk culture (9.2.4) • understand decision bias (9.2.4) • recommended risk response types (9.2.3.1, Table 9.1)	BL2
	4.5.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the risk practice (9.3.1, including subsections)	BL2
	4.6.1 Explain the purpose of the issues practice (10.1)	BL2
	4.6.2 Describe the key relationships between the issues practice and the principles (10.7, Table 10.3)	BL2
	4.6.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the issues practice (10.5): • PID: issue management approach • project log: issue register • issue report	BL2

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria	Bloom's Level
	4.6.4 Define key concepts related to the issues practice: • issue (including types of issue: change, problem/concern, business opportunity, request for change, off-specification) (10.1, 10.2.2, 10.2.3) • project baseline (10.1) • change control (10.2.3)	BL1
	4.6.5 Describe the guidance for effective management of issues: • baselines (10.2.1) • issue resolution (10.2.2) • change control (10.2.3) • delegating authority for changes (10.2.4) • change budget (10.2.5)	BL2
	4.6.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the issues practice (10.3.1, including subsections)	BL2
	4.7.1 Explain the purpose of the progress practice (11.1)	BL2
	4.7.2 Describe the key relationships between the progress practice and the principles (11.7, Table 11.4)	BL2
	4.7.3 Explain the purpose of the key management products required to support the progress practice (11.5): • checkpoint report • highlight report • end stage report • end project report • lessons report • exception report • project log: daily log • project log: lessons log • PID: digital and data management approach	BL2
	4.7.4 Define key concepts related to the progress practice: • forecast (11.1) • exception (11.1) • tolerance (11.2.1) • event-driven and time-driven controls (11.2.2)	BL1
	4.7.5 Describe the guidance for effective management of progress: • tolerances for progress control (11.2.1, excluding Table 11.1) • types of control (11.2.2) • reviewing progress and lessons (11.2.3) • reporting progress and lessons (11.2.4) • forecasting (11.2.5) • escalating (11.2.6, including subsections) • use of data and systems in progress management (11.2.7)	BL2
	4.7.6 Describe the PRINCE2 Project Management technique for the progress practice (11.3.1, including subsections)	BL2

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria	Bloom's Level
5. Understand the PRINCE2 Project Management processes and how they are carried out throughout the project	5.1 Explain the purpose of the PRINCE2 Project Management processes: • starting up a project (13.1) • directing a project (14.1) • initiating a project (15.1) • controlling a stage (16.1) • managing product delivery (17.1) • managing a stage boundary (18.1) • closing a project (19.1)	BL2
	5.2 Explain the objectives of the PRINCE2 Project Management processes: • starting up a project (13.2) • directing a project (14.2) • initiating a project (15.2) • controlling a stage (16.2) • managing product delivery (17.2) • managing a stage boundary (18.2) • closing a project (19.2)	BL2
	5.3 Explain the context of the PRINCE2 Project Management processes: • starting up a project (13.3) • directing a project (14.3) • initiating a project (15.3) • controlling a stage (16.3) • managing product delivery (17.3) • managing a stage boundary (18.3) • closing a project (19.3)	BL2

5. Exam Specification

The **PRINCE2® Project Management Foundation examination** will consist of **five** (**5**) sections with the following structure:

Learning Outcome	Weighting %
1. Understand key concepts relating to projects and PRINCE2 Project Management	3%
2. Understand how the PRINCE2 Project Management principles underpin the PRINCE2 Project Management method	8%
3. Understand the importance of people in successful projects	14%
4. Understand the PRINCE2 Project Management practices and how they are applied throughout the project	60%
5. Understand the PRINCE2 Project Management processes and how they are carried out throughout the project	15%
Total	**100%**

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